Sr. Technology Project Manager(TPM) Panel Interview – Candidate Scenario

Your total interview time will be 90 minutes. You will have 45 minutes for your presentation, including time for questions during your talk. After your presentation there will be an additional 30 min for the panel to ask further questions, and then 15 minutes where you are welcome to ask us any questions.. You may use PowerPoint or similar tools to support your presentation.

Scenario Overview

You have recently been assigned as the Project Manager for AT Retailers, a global e-commerce organization undergoing a major digital transformation. AT Retailers operates worldwide, with high traffic originating from North America, LATAM, and Europe. The company is moving from a legacy monolithic architecture to a modern microservices and API-driven landscape hosted across on-prem infrastructure and AWS.

Over the past several months, AT Retailers has acquired several companies and they need to migrate them from their existing cloud provider over to Akamai.

Additionally their existing sites are seeing security issues with bot attacks that use credential stuffing and scraping and the team needs your help addressing those issues.

In your role as the Project Manager, you are responsible for evaluating the problems, designing a high-level architecture, and outlining the delivery and security plan.

Key Challenges Identified by AT Retailers

1. Delivery Issues

- Customer has given us 30 days to get 5,000 hostnames onboarded
- New customer teams aren't trained in Akamai products yet will support the new onboardings.
- Sites need to be able to handle 5x traffic during peak events
- Existing images are sometimes slow to load
- Customer indicates testing is not necessary, they prefer to push to production then fix issues.
- Handling of customer resources across multiple geographies(Europe, US, Asia) as well as managing internal Akamai resources.

2. Bot Activity and Automated Threats

- DDOS attacks attempting to take down customers origin
- Legacy WAF Rule Sets out of date on some configurations
- Surge in credential stuffing attempts
- Inventory scraping by competitive bots
- Carding attempts targeting checkout APIs
- Bots using sophisticated evasion techniques (IP rotation, spoofed clients)

Your Task for the Interview Presentation

You will prepare a 45-minute presentation addressing the following:

A) Delivery & Project Management Strategy

Outline how you would lead the end-to-end delivery of this program, including:

- Phases of implementation (assessment, rollout, hardening, optimization)
- Coordination with multiple teams
- Change management
- Risk management and escalation approach

B) High-Level Security Architecture Using Akamai Products

Design a solution using Akamai's delivery and security portfolio.Your proposed architecture should show how we can onboard the customers' hostnames, solve their traffic and load problems as well as address the WAF, Bot, and API security challenges for both new and old sites.

C) Security Problem Analysis

Provide your assessment of the situation, including:

- Key risks and root causes
- Impact on the business (operational, financial, security posture)
- How WAF, Bot, and API security issues interrelate in this environment

Deliverables for the Interview

- A structured 30-minute presentation with slides
- High-level solution architecture using Akamai Products
- Clear Project Management style roadmap and execution plan
- Mention the competitive advantages of Akamai over other vendors in your proposed solution.
- Mention one Akamai Best Practice per product in your solution. (Akamai Internal candidates only)

Additional Material you may want to review

1. Akamai Content Delivery, Cybersecurity and Cloud Compute products
2. OWASP Top 10